strange battle between men, elephants, and horses. The defending army was equipped with bows and arrows which were operated by holding the bow down with one foot while pulling the string back as far as possible. In addition to soldiers, Porus had 200 trained war elephants in the fight who took their job seriously.

The clash at Hydaspes was probably the most formidable endured by the Macedonian army during its time in India. It stretched on for days while Alexander maneuvered his horses and troops across the river. Though Porus' own forces were courageous and clever, they were ultimately beaten by Alexander's. The Macedonian emperor was impressed by his adversary, however, and proposed a compromise in lieu of an outright takeover of the king's lands. Offered a role at the emperor's side as he continued to plow through India, Porus agreed and kept his kingdom as a subordinate leader under the Macedonian emperor. His knowledge and support were no doubt a great boon to the conquering army as it marched onward, this time to the east.

Just as the Dravidians and Aryans before him, Alexander the Great was fixated on the Indus River Valley. Even after thousands of years of human habitation, India's main waterway and floodplain were still the most valuable part of the land, providing not only a freshwater source but adjacent agricultural plots fertile and vast enough to feed cities full of citizens and soldiers. As such, the valley was not without its own local authority and protectorate, and after his monumental fight with King Porus, Alexander thought better of moving farther west along the path of the Indus. Instead, he shifted his plans and declared that the army would move along the Ganga, a waterway which had largely succeeded that of the old Sarasvati in location and importance.

The next adversary Alexander faced was Dhana Nanda, emperor of a vast tract of dynastic territory in the eastern section of modern India. Nanda was equipped with thousands of soldiers and more elephants even than King Porus, a fact that did nothing to dissuade the ambitious 30-year-old Alexander. It did, however, frighten his war-weary troops, most of whom had already been marching with the army for several years. By the time the Macedonian army reached the Beas River, just short of its intended destination, the invading troops had made an important decision: with or without Alexander the Great, they were throwing down their arms and returning home at long last. They were faced with the terrifying rumors of